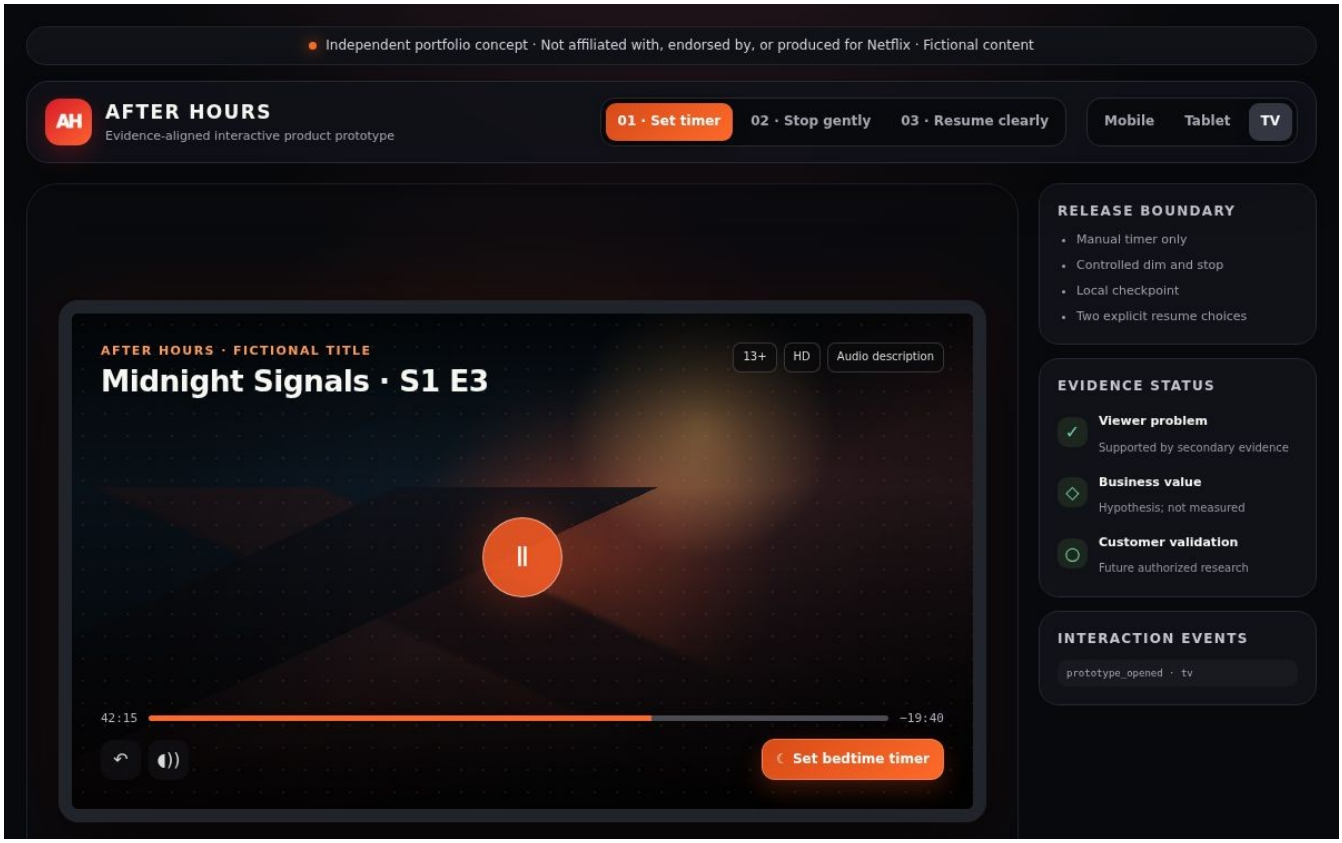
INDEPENDENT PRODUCT MANAGEMENT CASE STUDY

Netflix After Hours

Evidence aligned late night viewing concept and deployment ready interactive prototype

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The evidence-aligned release shows a manual bedtime timer, controlled stop, local checkpoint, and two explicit resume choices.

This is an independent portfolio concept. It was not produced for or with Netflix and does not represent Netflix customer research, telemetry, economics, UAT, or production delivery.

Executive decision

The case closes with a credible viewer problem and a deliberately bounded pilot, but without a demonstrated positive financial case.

Decision

Proceed only as a small, instrumented learning pilot if an authorized organization chooses to sponsor further validation. Do not use the current model to claim revenue, savings, ROI, or a Netflix investment decision.

Decision area	Final position
Viewer need	Directionally supported by independent secondary evidence
Pilot experience	Manual timer, cancellable dim and stop, local checkpoint, and resume choice
Customer validation	Not completed; future authorized research required
Economic result	Positive case not demonstrated
Portfolio outcome	Completed independent concept to decision case

What this case demonstrates

- Evidence governance that separates facts, hypotheses, targets, simulations, and missing inputs.
- A product-scope correction made when the original concept exceeded the available evidence.
- A complete chain from problem framing through research, prototype, measurement design, and investment decision.
- The willingness to close a gate honestly when a favourable answer cannot be supported.

Problem and opportunity

Late-night viewers can wake several episodes ahead, lose their true stopping point, or continue playback unintentionally. The product opportunity is to make that moment gentler and more recoverable.

Customer job

When I watch in bed and may fall asleep, help me stop playback without a disruptive interruption and return later without guessing where I was.

Original opportunity thesis

The original suite combined manual sleep controls, display dimming, sleep-point recovery, optional audio transitions, wearable automation, Premium positioning, and delivery-cost savings. It offered a broad vision but treated several unvalidated mechanisms as if they belonged in one release.

Evidence-led reframing

Original assumption	Evidence decision
Wearables can infer sleep reliably	Deferred to a future feasibility track
Advanced audio improves sleep	Removed; no therapeutic or sleep-quality claim
Premium prompts create conversion	Removed from pilot and held at zero in the model
Unattended playback creates measurable savings	Retained only as a measurable operational hypothesis
A fixed late-night window fits all viewers	Replaced with user-initiated controls

Research strategy

Direct Netflix customer research was not appropriate for an independent portfolio project, so Phase 2 used public secondary evidence to test the baselines without implying sponsorship or access.

Research governance

- No respondent was represented as a Netflix customer recruited for this project.
- No internal Netflix data, product metrics, costs, or confidential information were used.
- Public evidence established context and adjacent interaction patterns, not product-specific outcomes.

Baseline result

Baseline	Disposition	Implication
Bedtime viewing is a credible context	Supported	Continue the customer-problem track
Manual timers are an established pattern	Supported	Use a familiar user-controlled interaction
Falling asleep during paid streaming is frequent	Unresolved	Do not claim incidence
Recovery choices improve satisfaction	Unresolved	Test desirability and correction rate
Retention or conversion improves	Unsupported	Set financial contribution to zero
Delivery savings are material	Unresolved	Require internal marginal-value inputs

Gate 2 therefore passed conditionally: the context was credible enough to prototype, but severity, frequency, desirability, and economics remained unvalidated.

Pilot product

The first viable release is intentionally small. It tests whether viewers value intentional stopping and transparent recovery before the product takes on device integrations or commercial packaging.

Release promise

Set a simple bedtime stop, receive a low-disruption warning, and return later with two clear choices about where to resume.

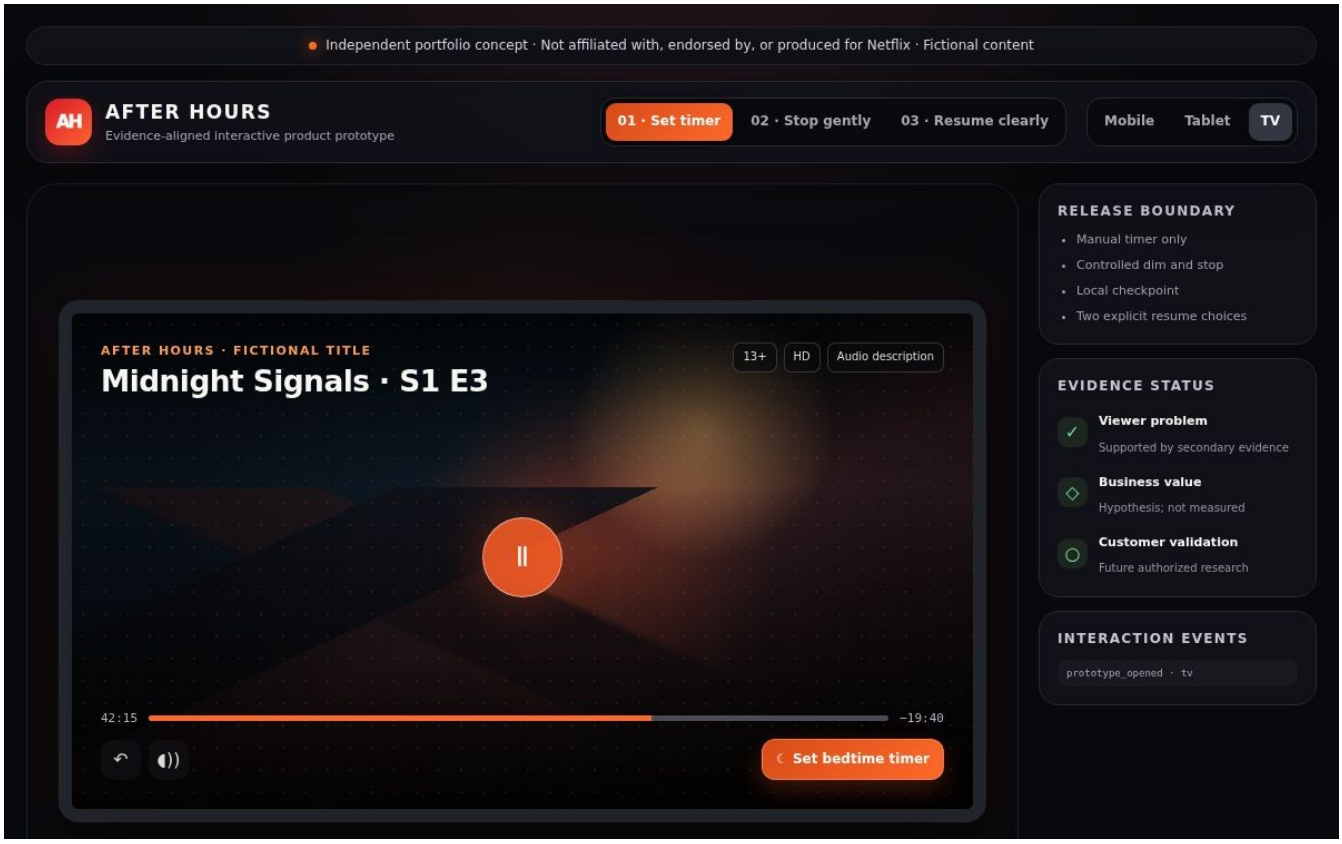
Included	Deferred or excluded
15, 30, and 45 minute timers	Wearable sleep detection
End of episode option	Cross-device checkpoint synchronization
Gradual display dimming	Binaural or therapeutic audio
Immediate cancellation through input	Premium upsell
Local checkpoint	Fixed global late-night activation
Checkpoint and latest-position choices	Quantified retention, conversion, or savings claims

Safety and trust principles

- User initiation and immediate cancellation take priority over automation.
- Recovery choices explain their source instead of silently changing playback history.
- Local state is sufficient for the concept; cloud synchronization requires a separate privacy and feasibility decision.

Experience design

The prototype demonstrates three linked user journeys across TV, tablet, and mobile layouts. Each state is fictional and instrumented only in the browser session.



Journey	User action	Product response
Set timer	Choose 15, 30, 45 minutes, or episode end	Confirm the choice without leaving playback
Stop gently	Allow the countdown or cancel through input	Dim, show a clear countdown, then save locally
Resume clearly	Choose checkpoint or latest position	Resume from the explicitly selected state

Prototype verification

The release was rebuilt as a self-contained static application so it can be audited, deployed, and reviewed without third-party runtime dependencies.

Verification area	Result
Build parity	Root, prototype mirror, and static deployment output match
Runtime dependencies	No external scripts, fonts, images, APIs, analytics, or storage calls
Interaction paths	Timer, controlled stop, resume choice, and device switching rendered successfully
Keyboard and dialog behaviour	Focus state, Escape close, focus trap, and reduced-motion support implemented
Browser console	No application errors observed; extension-only messages excluded
Deployment	Private sandbox deployment completed; repository remains host-ready

Maturity boundary

Deployment verifies the front-end interaction package. It does not establish a production service, Netflix integration, telemetry pipeline, cloud synchronization, device certification, security review, or UAT completion.

Repository release

The active release is available in the public GitHub repository with a one-command check, static-host instructions, archived original artifacts, and the full decision trail.

Measurement and experiment design

The pilot is designed to learn whether viewers use the control, accept the stop, recover successfully, and avoid unwanted interruptions. Targets are decision thresholds, not results.

Question	Primary measure	Decision use
Do eligible viewers activate it?	Activation rate	Desirability and discoverability
Does the timer complete as intended?	Controlled-stop completion	Core interaction value
Is the stop unwanted?	Cancellation and immediate restart	Guardrail and trust
Does recovery help?	Checkpoint selection and correction	Resume-value validation
Does behaviour change?	Avoided continuation minutes	Operational value input
Does it affect retention?	Experiment retention delta	Future commercial evidence only

Evidence labels

Observed telemetry, experiment estimates, model assumptions, research benchmarks, and product targets must remain separate fields in any dashboard or decision memo. Synthetic metrics can validate computation but cannot validate customer behaviour.

Value case

The normalized model can calculate physical stream-hours under labelled assumptions, but it cannot support a positive financial conclusion without internal marginal-value and cost inputs.

Value pathway	Conservative treatment	Reason
Retention	Zero	No causal customer evidence
Premium conversion	Zero	No observed conversion evidence
Avoided stream-hours	Computable	Requires assumed activation, completion, and minutes
Marginal delivery value	Unavailable	Not available from public evidence
Implementation cost	Unavailable	Requires engineering and certification estimates
Operating cost	Unavailable	Requires an authorized operating model

Gate 4 conclusion

Gate 4 closed as not demonstrated rather than failed. The product hypothesis was not disproven; the investment conclusion could not be evaluated responsibly with the evidence available to an independent portfolio case.

Approval of this disposition records a completed decision process. It is not approval of a positive business case.

Roadmap and future evidence

Any future work should earn the right to expand the concept. Evidence precedes feature growth.

Stage	Outcome	Evidence required to advance
1 Authorized discovery	Estimate frequency, severity, and desirability	Recruitment approval and documented sample
2 Usability pilot	Validate timer and resume comprehension	Task success, correction, unwanted-stop evidence
3 Instrumented experiment	Measure behaviour change	Eligible sessions, activation, completion, avoided minutes
4 Economic review	Reopen Gate 4	Marginal value plus build and run cost estimates
5 Feasibility tracks	Consider sync and wearables	Privacy, platform, certification, and reliability proof

Future evidence backlog

The backlog should be managed as evidence work, not assumed delivery scope. Each item must name the decision it unlocks, the evidence class it produces, and the claim it is permitted to change.

Product leadership reflection

The strongest outcome of this case is not a favourable forecast. It is a more defensible product decision and a clear record of how the concept changed under evidence.

What changed

The original concept was broad and visually compelling, but it combined customer, technical, health, and commercial assumptions. Research narrowed the pilot to a user-controlled interaction that can be tested without making unsupported claims. The original suite remains archived as a traceable learning artifact.

What I would do inside an authorized organization

- Partner with legal, research, privacy, finance, playback, and device-platform owners before recruitment or instrumentation.
- Run a small usability study before exposing any stop automation to live viewing sessions.
- Pre-register success and guardrail thresholds, then hold the financial gate until internal cost inputs exist.
- Use the first release to learn, not to justify the original concept retroactively.

Final portfolio statement

Netflix After Hours is a completed independent concept-to-decision product case with a deployment-ready interactive prototype. The viewer problem is credible, the first pilot is bounded, and the evidence gaps are explicit. Customer validation, production feasibility, and positive economics remain future work.

Repository: https://github.com/dudedumebi-gif/netflix-after-hours-product-case

Portfolio: https://dumebi-ai-ba-portfolio.dudedumebi.chatgpt.site/